



MONTHLY UPDATE

Egypt: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 45 systems and instruments tracked, 55 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Egypt used the window to publish the shape of its digital state rather than to add to it. A cabinet meeting on 19 July 2026 set out 105 government bodies connected and 100 national databases linked through the digital switch, a digital treasury of reusable verified documents, and live e-signature and e-seal services ([cabinet readout](#)). Two days later the ICT minister put 242 services on the national platform against a target of about 450 by 2030 ([ministerial briefing](#)).

Cabinet then agreed on 29 July to review the social-media statutes and raise financial penalties, after the ICT minister disclosed that a regulator unit already acts on artificial-intelligence-manipulated media ([cabinet account](#)); and Egypt was elected on 31 July to chair two working groups of the Arab AI committee ([election account](#)).

Infrastructure

An independent measurement published on 3 August 2026 gave the first full-year reading of Egypt's 5G launch. Six months after commercial service began in June 2025, the 5G median download speed had fallen to about 89 Mbps from 110.5 Mbps on launch day, and the combined 4G and 5G median stood at 34.77 Mbps against a pre-launch baseline of 37.68 Mbps ([measurement](#)). Egypt is the only one of the four North African launch markets with no published coverage or quality obligation attached to its award.

The data-centre position moved by cancellation. Telecom Egypt's board withdrew on 17 July from the agreement to sell 75-80% of its Regional Data Center Hub because the conditions were not met; the hub is instead to be carved out as a wholly-owned subsidiary ([cancellation account](#)). Neither the consideration nor the unmet conditions were disclosed.

Digital public infrastructure

The 19 July cabinet meeting produced the window's substantive disclosure: 105 government bodies connected and 100 national databases linked through the government digital switch, with the digital treasury's operating model applied to a number of services and e-signature and e-seal live and integrated with digital identity ([cabinet readout](#)). No register of the connected bodies, lawful basis or audit arrangement accompanies the figures.

The treasury's first consuming service followed on 27 July, when public shop licensing opened on the national platform. It standardises procedures nationwide, binds authorities to a maximum three-month approval, issues an immediate temporary operating permit, and deems approval where an authority fails to respond. The Arabic account carries the enforcement half absent from the English ones — penalties applied to unlicensed shops, agencies canvassing premises, and the stated object of building a complete database of every commercial premises in Egypt ([launch account](#)).

Two further services opened: the Public Prosecution began returning, through the national digital identity system, criminal judgments registered against an enquirer's own national number, and digital visa-on-arrival began at Cairo International on 1 August, with an issuance fee charged on top of the visa fee.

The social insurance authority reported on 3 August that it had served 8,621,000 people in about four months and cleared 92% of its arrears backlog — while the 95 online services it undertook in February within six months remained forthcoming as that window fell due ([authority account](#)).

Governance and regulation

A cabinet meeting chaired by the Prime Minister agreed on 29 July 2026 to review the statutes governing social media and to raise financial penalties, with the ICT ministry preparing a comparative study of other states' regimes. In the same meeting the minister disclosed that a unit inside the telecommunications regulator already detects and acts on artificial-intelligence-manipulated video and imagery, and said that legislative amendment is still needed to address the practices at root ([cabinet account](#)). The unit's formation date, legal basis, staffing, method and appeal route were not stated.

Nine days earlier a member of parliament had called for a comprehensive standalone digital-privacy bill criminalising the recording and publication of people without consent, imposing takedown duties on platforms and widening investigators' powers to trace anonymous accounts, arguing that the Cybercrime Law and the Penal Code are insufficient in practice. The demand does not refer to the Personal Data Protection Law of 2020 at any point ([demand](#)).

On 4 August the Ministry of Justice gazetted a deferral of the title-based property register for one Sohag survey section by a year to July 2027, and the state-land regularisation platform was reported at more than 302,000 applications received against about 1,700 contracts drawn up ([platform figures](#)).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Egypt took the chairmanship of two Arab working groups on 31 July 2026 — AI governance, whose remit is a guidance framework and mechanisms for activating the Arab Charter for AI Ethics, and quantum computing, whose remit is an Arab quantum strategy and quantum-cybersecurity deployment. The committee was created by an Arab ministerial resolution at a session Egypt hosted in January 2026 and held its first founding meeting at the ICT ministry in May ([election account](#)).

Two outsourcing commitments were made in the same fortnight. A group inaugurated its Middle East and Africa regional headquarters and first global generative-AI centre of excellence in New Cairo on 28 July, backed by a company-stated US\$100m with about 800 staff ([inauguration account](#)). A professional services firm signed a memorandum with the IT industry agency on 6 July for a regional outsourcing delivery centre stated to create more than 1,000 jobs over three years, with no investment sum, site or opening date given.

The state's university artificial-intelligence programme closed its fourth round on 4 August with 1,090 students and 445 projects, taking the cumulative total since 2022 to 2,710 students ([round account](#)). A tripartite agreement added mentoring and real healthcare datasets to student projects, with no data-governance arrangement stated for the patient-derived data.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The month's clearest inclusion move was a reopening rather than an extension. From 24 July the state accepted ration-card grievance and data-update forms at 500 post offices on Friday afternoons and Saturday mornings, alongside the online route that had until then been the only channel for appeals against the 2026 eligibility criteria, with a daily adjudication committee, results notified by text message and every case checked against official databases.

Accessibility followed a similar pattern of demonstration without obligation. On 4 August the ICT ministry published an accessibility toolbar on every page of its own site under a presidential initiative, executed by the ministry's academy for persons with disabilities, whose mandate is to propagate the standards to other government bodies. No deadline, list of bound entities, conformance level or audit route was stated ([ministry account](#)).

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